Driver training syllabus

The 19 topics we work through, in order, from the first welcome to final feedback. Tick each one off as you go. Built on 30 years of driving and training experience and my time as a DVSA examiner. How long each topic takes depends on your licence category, your vehicle and where you are in your training.

1 ☐ **Welcome and introductions**

We start by getting to know each other: who you are, what you want from the training, and what you already drive. I explain how the course will run and talk through your test details if you have a test booked.

2 ☐ **Introduction to the vehicle**

External and internal checks, the vehicle safety questions, and setting up your seat and mirrors properly. I also introduce the routines we use throughout: mirrors, signal, manoeuvre (MSM); position, speed, look (PSL); and look, assess, decide, act (LADA).

3 ☐ **Moving away and stopping**

Moving away safely in every situation: normal, uphill, downhill and at an angle, followed by stopping in the right place, under control.

4 ☐ **Emerging**

Judging when it is safe to pull out at junctions, with good observation and no hesitation or rushing.

5 ☐ **Positioning**

Choosing the right place on the road, on straight roads, at bends and approaching junctions, and holding it consistently.

6 ☐ **Meeting traffic**

Dealing with oncoming vehicles, narrow roads and parked cars, and knowing when to hold back and when to go.

7 ☐ **Turning left**

Approach, observation, speed and positioning for left turns, using the MSM, PSL and LADA routines.

8 ☐ **Turning right**

The same routines applied to right turns, including waiting safely and judging gaps in oncoming traffic.

9 ☐ **Roundabouts**

Reading the roundabout early, getting into the correct lane, signalling correctly and watching other traffic all the way round.

10 ☐ **Speed**

Using appropriate speed for the road, the traffic and the conditions, neither too fast nor holding others up.

11 ☐ **Traffic lights**

Approaching, stopping and moving away at traffic lights, including reading how long a green light has been showing.

12 ☐ **Road markings**

Understanding what the markings are telling you, including road numbers, and positioning in good time as a result.

13 **Signs** ☐
Spotting and reacting to road signs and road numbers early, and pre-positioning for where you need to go.

14 **Signals** ☐
Using signals correctly: clear, timely and only when they help other road users.

15 **Rules of assessment** ☐
How driving is assessed, including driving, serious and dangerous faults, and what it means when an examiner takes action, verbally or physically. Knowing the rules removes a lot of the mystery on test day.

16 **Test brief** ☐
What to expect at the start of a test: how long it lasts, the health and safety points, how the debrief works and the licence check.

17 **Economics** ☐
Driving economically to get more range from every tank or battery charge, whether diesel, petrol or electric, saving fuel and energy and reducing wear on the vehicle. Fuel-saving skills are part of all my driver training.

18 **Test nerves** ☐
Practical tools to help you stay calm and focused during the test, so nerves don't cost you marks.

19 **Feedback review** ☐
We finish by going through how it went: what you did well, what to keep working on, and the next steps.

Ready to book your training?
Tell me what you drive and when your test is, and I'll plan the days around you. Call or WhatsApp **07807 395913**, email **info@avdt.co.uk** or visit **avdt.co.uk** for a clear quote.